binaries written in C for handling specific web-related tasks… PHP was also originally a DSL of sorts). DSLs are characterized by restricted syntax and a narrow focus: they are not intended to solve problems outside of their specific domain but will make working on in-scope problems much easier. Think of Twig as a way of restricting access to the full spectrum of PHP functionality, focusing only on the parts that assist the creation of (hyper) text and wrapping those parts in a markup-like syntax that plays nicely inside HTML documents (or any other type of template; you can generate anything you like with Twig).

If you run into difficulties when trying to achieve something with Twig that would otherwise be trivial to accomplish in PHP, there's likely a very good reason: you are no longer solving a view problem, and you probably need to look elsewhere in the MVC architecture. Earlier I gave the example of database access inside a template: Twig offers precisely no functions for this (out of the box, anyway), because data processing is a concern of the model, not the view. Ditto messing about with HTTP requests: that's a controller's job, not something you should have to do when rendering a view. It is possible to extend Twig and define your own functions for use in templates, but you should be *very* wary of doing so!

Getting Started with Twig

Use composer to install Twig in the directory of your choice, make sure that the sub-directories `views` and `cache` exist, and create the following `composer.json` file:

```
{
    "name": "exphp8/generate-with-twig",
    "description": "Exploring PHP8 - Twig rendering examples",
    "type": "project",
    "minimum-stability": "dev",
    "require": {
        "twig/twig": "4.x-dev",
        "twig/html-extra": "4.x-dev"
    }
}
```